# Describing people and places

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

## Qué vas a aprender

- Describe what people look like (aspecto físico)
- Describe personality (carácter) with adjectives
- Describe places with there is / there are and prepositions
- Put adjectives in the right order before the noun

## Para pensar

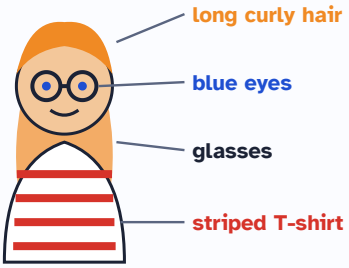
**«What does she look like?» y «What is she like?» parecen casi iguales. ¿Preguntan lo mismo?**

## Explicación

### Appearance: body and face

To describe **appearance** (aspecto) we use *be* and *have got*. With be: «He **is** tall / short / medium height», «She **is** young / old», «They **are** slim / strong».

With have got: «She **has got** blue eyes», «He **has got** a beard / a moustache / freckles (pecas)». We also say «He **wears** glasses». **En castellano:** en inglés no se dice «es de ojos azules», sino «tiene ojos azules»: *has got blue eyes*. Y los adjetivos no tienen plural: «blue eyes», nunca «blues eyes».




### Hair

For **hair** we usually say length, then style, then colour: long / short / medium-length, straight / wavy / curly, blond / brown / black / red / grey. «She's got **long curly brown** hair», «He's got **short straight black** hair». We can also say «He's **bald**» (calvo) or «She has got a **ponytail**» (coleta).

**En castellano:** *hair* es incontable cuando hablamos del pelo de la cabeza: «Her hair **is** long», no «her hairs are».



## Personality

To describe **personality** (carácter) we ask  What is he like? . Positive adjectives: **kind** (amable), **friendly** (simpático), **funny** (gracioso), **clever** (listo), **brave** (valiente), **hard-working** (trabajador), **generous**, **patient**, **calm**.

Negative ones: **lazy** (vago), **bossy** (mandón), **shy** (tímido, not really negative!), **rude** (maleducado), **moody**. Give an example to show it: «My grandpa is very **patient**: he always helps me with my homework». **Consejo:** usa *very*, *quite* y *a bit* para matizar.

| Positive | Negative |
|---|---|
| **kind** | rude |
| **hard-working** | lazy |
| **brave** | bossy |
| **calm** | moody |

## Adjective order

In English, adjectives go **before** the noun: «a **big** house», never «a house big». When there are several, they follow an order:  opinion – size – age – shape – colour – material  + noun.

«a **beautiful old** castle», «a **small round wooden** table», «a **nice big red** bike». **En castellano:** en español el adjetivo suele ir detrás («una casa grande»), por eso en inglés hay que pensar al revés. No uses más de dos o tres adjetivos seguidos.

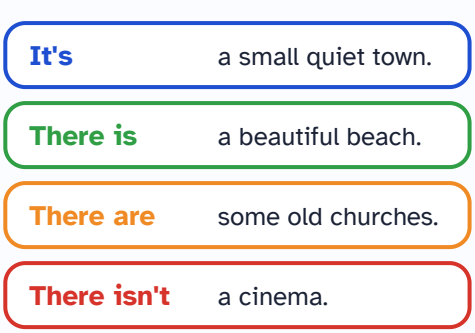



opinion · size · age · colour + noun

## Describing places

To describe a place we use there is / there are and adjectives: «My town is **small** and **quiet**. There **is** a **beautiful** beach and there **are** some **old** churches. There **isn't** a cinema».

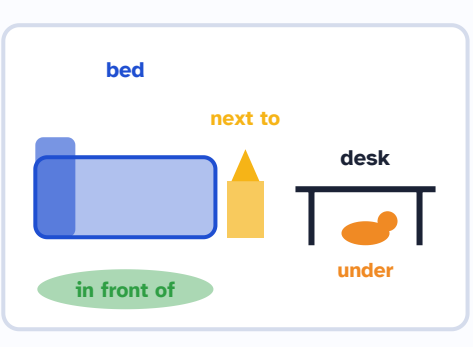
Useful adjectives for places: **big, small, busy** (con mucha gente), **quiet** (tranquilo), **noisy** (ruidoso), **modern, old, clean, dirty, crowded, peaceful**. **En castellano:** empieza por lo general (cómo es) y luego explica qué hay.




## Where is it? Prepositions of place

Prepositions of place say where things are: **in** (dentro), **on** (encima), **under** (debajo), **next to** (al lado de), **between** (entre), **behind** (detrás), **in front of** (delante de), **opposite** (enfrente de), **near** (cerca).

«The lamp is **next to** the bed», «The cat is **under** the desk», «The bank is **opposite** the park», «The school is **between** the library and the pool». **En castellano:** ojo con *in front of* (delante) y *opposite* (enfrente, al otro lado).




## Reading: my best friend and my street

Read Adam's description: «My best friend is Sofía. She's quite tall and she has got **short wavy black** hair and **big brown** eyes. She wears glasses. She's very **funny**

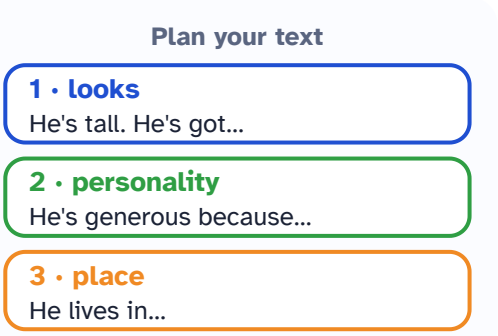
and **kind**, but a bit **shy** with new people. She lives in my street. It's a **quiet** street with **tall** trees. There's a bakery **next to** her house and there's a small park **opposite** my flat. We play there every afternoon».




## Writing a description

Plan your description in **three paragraphs** (párrafos): 1) **Who** and **appearance** («My uncle Javi is tall...»), 2) **personality** with examples («He's very generous: he always...»), 3) **place** or **activities** («He lives in a flat near the sea...»).

Use connectors: **and**, **but**, **also**, **because**. «She's shy **but** very friendly», «I like him **because** he's funny». **Consejo:** relee tu texto para comprobar el orden de los adjetivos y que hayas usado *has got* con los ojos y el pelo.

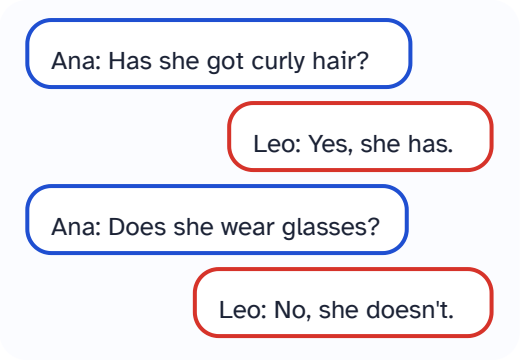



## Let's practise: Guess who?

Play «Guess who?» with pictures of people or classmates (with respect!). Ask only yes/no questions: «Has he got curly hair?» – «No, he hasn't». «Is she wearing a red jumper?» – «Yes, she is». «Does he wear glasses?» – «Yes, he does».

Then describe a place in the classroom without saying its name: «It's next to the window and opposite the door. There are lots of books on it». Your partner

guesses: «The bookshelf!». **Consejo:** describe con respeto, sin palabras que puedan molestar a nadie.




## Describing people and places

| What does he look like? | What is he like? | adjective order | places |
|---|---|---|---|
| **LOOKS** | **PERSONALITY** | **NICE BIG RED** | **NEXT TO** |
| tall, short hair<br>has got blue eyes | kind, funny<br>a bit shy | opinion, size,<br>colour + noun | under, opposite<br>there is / are |

## Ejercicios

1. **Translate: «Tiene el pelo corto y rizado.»**

2. **Order: «car / red / a / small».**

3. **Write the opposite: tall, quiet, lazy, old.**

4. **Which question asks about personality?**

5. **Complete: «The bank is ___ the park.» (enfrente de)**

6. **Complete: «My bag is ___ my chair.» (debajo de)**

7. **Correct: «My sister has got browns eyes.»**

8. **Complete: «There ___ two parks in my town.»**

9. **Describe your bedroom in two sentences.**

10. **Describe a family member in three sentences.**

## Practica

1. **«What does she look like?» asks about...**

   **A)** personality
   **B)** appearance
   **C)** hobbies

2. **«What is he like?» asks about...**

   **A)** appearance
   **B)** his job
   **C)** personality

3. **«She ___ got green eyes.»**

   **A)** has
   **B)** is
   **C)** have

4. **Correct order:**

   **A)** an old beautiful house
   **B)** a house beautiful old
   **C)** a beautiful old house

5. **«Curly» describes...**

   **A)** eyes
   **B)** hair
   **C)** personality

6. **Someone who never wants to work is...**

   **A)** lazy
   **B)** brave
   **C)** kind

7. **«The ball is ___ the box.» (dentro)**

   **A)** on
   **B)** in
   **C)** under

8. **«delante de» is...**

   **A)** behind

**B)** opposite

**C)** in front of

9. **«Her hair ___ long.»**

**A)** is

**B)** are

**C)** have

10. **A place with lots of noise is...**

**A)** quiet

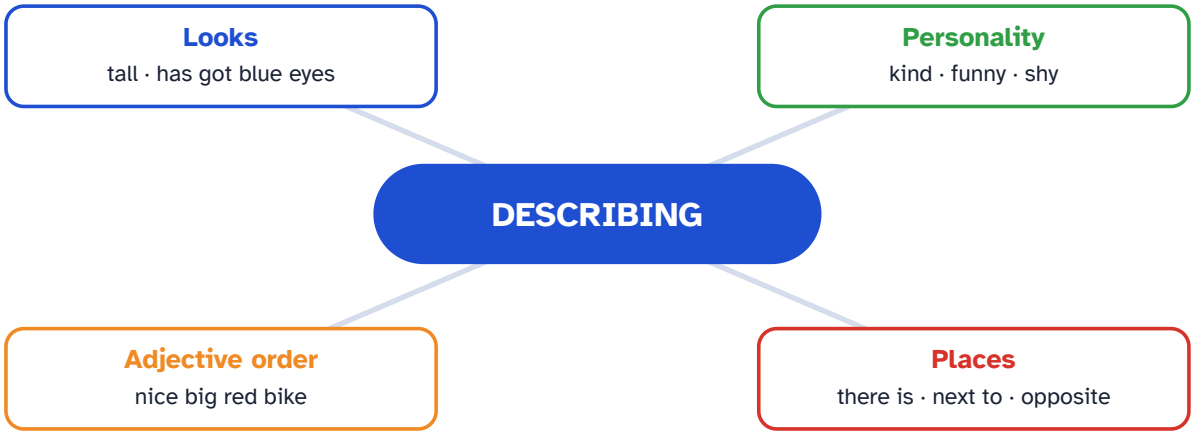
**B)** noisy

**C)** peaceful

## Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Diferencia entre What is he like? y What does he look like?; Cómo describir el pelo y los ojos; En qué orden van los adjetivos; Cómo describir un lugar con there is / there are y preposiciones.

## Resumen



## Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

**What does she look like?**

¿Cómo es físicamente?

**What is she like?**

¿Cómo es de carácter?

**has got blue eyes**

Tiene los ojos azules.

**long curly hair**

Pelo largo y rizado.

**kind / funny / shy**

Amable / gracioso / tímido.

**Adjective order**

Opinión, tamaño, edad, color + nombre.

**in front of / behind**

Delante de / detrás de.

**opposite**

Enfrente de.

## Soluciones

1. **B)** Aspecto físico.
2. **C)** Forma de ser.
3. **A)** She + has got.
4. **C)** Opinión antes que edad.
5. **B)** Pelo rizado.
6. **A)** Lazy = vago.
7. **B)** In = dentro.
8. **C)** In front of.
9. **A)** Hair es incontable.
10. **B)** Noisy = ruidoso.

## Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. She has got short curly hair (o He has got...).
2. a small red car.
3. short, noisy, hard-working, young (o new).
4. What is he like?
5. opposite.
6. under.
7. My sister has got brown eyes.
8. are.
9. Model answer: There is a bed next to the window. My desk is opposite the door.
10. Model answer: My mum is tall. She has got short brown hair. She's very kind and funny.